

Building What Comes Next Inside Mercuri's Vision for the Future

Mercuri has successfully built and operated businesses across multiple domains and geographies. What has been the vision behind this diversified journey?

Our vision has always been to identify meaningful opportunities where technology, people and innovation can create lasting value. Mercuri has evolved across media, entertainment, sports, technology, education and other sectors because we believe innovation often happens at the intersection of different disciplines. The objective has never been diversification for its own sake, but to build businesses and institutions that can create meaningful and sustainable impact.

You have previously spoken about looking beyond profits when building businesses. How does that philosophy shape your decisions?

Commercial Profits are important for sustainability, but it cannot be the only measure of success. I believe some initiatives should be driven by their ability to solve meaningful problems, create knowledge or contribute to society. The Centre for Music, Brain, Mind and Health is a good example. The larger objective is to bring together music, neuroscience, medicine, psychology and technology to create an ecosystem that can benefit society for generations.

Mercuri also has a portfolio of some big sports properties. How do you see the sports business evolving within the group?

Sports has always been an important part of Mercuri's journey, we have built and developed a number of properties across different sporting ecosystems. Our focus going forward is to build these IPs into stronger & bigger by

combining sports, technology, content and fan engagement. We also see significant potential in using AI and data-driven solutions to enhance performance analytics, content creation and audience engagement, while creating greater long-term value around the properties.

Looking ahead, which areas within Mercuri do you see as particularly promising and deserving of greater focus?

We see significant potential in the entertainment and content business, particularly in South India, and which is of our interest and is increasingly attracting audiences and interests globally. Our partnership with Connekt Media, involving a planned investment of ₹925 crore towards a slate of multiple mega-budget films, reflects our confidence in this opportunity. Beyond movies, we will focus on OTT and original IPs, while using technology and AI to explore new possibilities in content creation and storytelling.

Live entertainment and events are becoming an increasingly important part of India's growth story. How do you see this space evolving, and where does Mercuri see an opportunity?

I believe the live events industry is still at a relatively early stage in India, with significant growth ahead. Mercuri



Sriram Bakthisaran

Managing Director & Group CEO
Mercuri Group

already has experience in this space, having delivered over 100 live music concerts globally over the years, we have seen first-hand how audiences are increasingly seeking memorable, high-quality experiences. What is particularly exciting is that this growth is no longer limited to the metros. Tier-2 and Tier-3 cities are becoming important markets, while audiences are increasingly willing to travel and spend more on premium experiences. For Mercuri, the opportunity is to build meaningful experiences around this growing consumer appetite. The real opportunity is not simply the size of the industry, but the ability to create experiences by bringing together content, audiences, brands in a scalable & sustainable way systematically.